

I WANT MY STUFF BACK

I Samuel 27:1-7

INTRO: (Relate the story of David being anointed by Samuel – Eliab, Abinadab - – Shammah – 7 sons passed by and the Lord chose none of them, though some of them looked like Kingly material! - God will NEVER anoint the flesh – David fights Goliath)

Saul's jealousy caused him to hate David, thus he pursued David to kill him. It did not help that the women were in the streets singing *“Saul hath*

killed his thousands, David his ten thousands.”

After a while David became weary with all the pressures of being pursued and he began to take matters into his own hands, and actually hatched a plan to move his family and his followers to Ziklag, a city in the land of the Philistines.

During this time David had opportunity to kill Saul on two different occasions but refused to do so, saying, ***“I refuse to touch God’s anointed.”*** (God always has a set person – They are all flawed – He alone

decides when to set them up
and when to take them down –
We are to never judge upward
or horizontally – Never judge a
person you have no jurisdiction
over – Leave that to God and
the authorities over them)

I personally don't believe that it
was within the will of God for
David to be in the land of the
Philistines in the first place.
(Expound on the fact that God
had already decided David
would be the next King of
Israel)

Could it be that if David had
not fled from Saul that he

would have been King much sooner?

If one is to do the will of God, there must be a boatload of commitment in the bad times as well as the good times.

After a proving period, David asks Achish, King of Gath to allow he and his men to move to a small town called Ziklag. 1 Samuel 27:7 (KJV) ***“The time that David dwelt in the country of the Philistines was a full year and four months.”***

Ziklag represents a hiding place or refuge outside the known

will of God! Most of the time it represents the path of least resistance.

Notice if you will, that David didn't stay in Ziklag all the time, from time to time he would go onto Saul's turf and when the pressure was on, he would return to Ziklag! (Sound familiar?)

After an undetermined amount of time, David was even willing to help Achish fight Saul!

Remember, before Ziklag, David spared Saul's life on two different occasions, saying, ***"I***

refuse to touch God's

anointed!" Sixteen months of living outside the known will of God causes one to do things they never thought they were capable of doing! (Beware, the danger of the gradual – The little foxes spoil the vines)

Look closely at the results of sixteen months of hiding, retreating, self-pity and living in fear. Ziklag burns! While David and his men were out of town:

- The city was raided...
- Their stuff was taken...
- Their wives and children were kidnapped...

- The city was burned to the ground...

Notice the devastation of David and his men. 1 Samuel 30:3-4 (KJV) *“So David and his men came to the city, and, behold, it was burned with fire; and their wives, and their sons, and their daughters, were taken captives. 4 Then David and the people that were with him lifted up their voice and wept, until they had no more power to weep.”* Weeping warriors seems to me to be a misnomer. Think of this, the fiercest warriors the world had

ever seen, were weeping for their losses.

There are weeping warriors in this room today! The Lord spoke these words to me -

“There is a time for weeping but this is a time for faith.”

David immediately did what he knew would work; he went to God in prayer about the matter.

I Samuel 30:6-8 (NKJV) *Now David was greatly distressed, for the people spoke of stoning him, because the soul of all the people was grieved, every man for his sons and his daughters. But David*

strengthened himself in the LORD his God. ⁷ Then David said to Abiathar the priest, Ahimelech's son, "Please bring the ephod here to me." And Abiathar brought the ephod to David. ⁸ So David inquired of the LORD, saying, "Shall I pursue this troop? Shall I overtake them?" And He answered him, "Pursue, for you shall surely overtake them and without fail recover all."

David decided he wanted his stuff back! The most dangerous person on the planet is the individual who has

decided he/she wants their stuff
back and is willing to do
anything to get it back!
Righteous indignation is an
attribute the modern-day church
needs to acquire! Passivism is
the neutering of the church!

While pursuing this band of
criminals David discovered an
Egyptian who had been left
behind because he was sick.
There is no respect among
thieves!

We must be careful how we
treat people who intersect our
path in our darkest seasons,

they very well may have to
code to our victory!

In our darkest season the Lord
will often cause our paths to
intersect with folks who don't:

- Look like us...
- Believe like us...
- Think like us...
- Live like us...

Could it be that something in
the way we have done things,
and thought about things, may
have contributed to the situation
we find ourselves in?

God may very well be trying to
change our thinking so we can

go where HE wants us, not
where we had initially planned
to go on our own!

David fed and restored this
man, and in turn he led them to
the enemies, and David
recovered all!

David got his stuff back! What
are we going to do? What do
we need to take back?

- Our joy?
- Our peace?
- Our life?
- Our family?
- Our ministry?
- Your health?
- Our wealth?

I felt the Lord prompting me to give us a prescription for success:

- Pray until we have our stuff back...
- Believe until we have our stuff back...
- Pursue until we have our stuff back...

PLACES PREACHED:

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